

Migrating from server A to B

Example source: `wiki.EXAMPLE.COM`

Example destination: `newwiki.EXAMPLE.COM`

Preparing new machine

1. Provision new server. Note `IP_ADDRESS` of the new machine.
2. Add a DNS A record for `IP_ADDRESS`. Example: if your existing domain is `example.com`, maybe your new record is `newwiki` for `newwiki.example.com`.
3. Set up SSH access. (I recommend setting up an ssh `config` file at `~/.ssh/config` so you can simply say `ssh newwiki`.)
4. Create an installer config file (see below for an example).
5. Upload the config file to the server's `/tmp` directory: `scp config.sh newwiki:/tmp/`. (notice the period at the end)
6. Upload the installation script to the server's `/tmp` directory: `scp install_mediawiki.sh newwiki:/tmp/`. (notice the period at the end)
7. Log into the new server: `ssh newwiki`
8. Change to root (superuser): `sudo su -`
9. Change directories to `/tmp`: `cd /tmp`
10. Make the install script executable and run it: `chmod +x install_mediawiki.sh ; ./install_mediawiki.sh`
11. Wait a while for everything to install and configure.

Preparing old machine

1. Set up a read-only message. `$wgReadOnly = 'Down for maintenance: access will be restored shortly';`
2. Save a copy of `LocalSettings.php`.
3. Create a database backup.
`mysqldump --user=wikidb_user --password=wikidb_userpassword wikidb > /tmp/backup.sql`
4. Zip the database backup: `gzip /tmp/backup.sql`
5. Download the dump onto your laptop: `scp oldmachine:/tmp/backup.sql.gz .`
6. *Maybe* make a copy of the entire `mediawiki` directory...?

Finishing new machine

1. Upload the database dump to the new machine: `scp backup.sql.gz newwiki:/tmp/.`
2. Unzip the backup: `gunzip /tmp/backup.sql.gz`
3. Restore the backup. NOTE: this will wipe out whatever is on the new machine's database! `mysql -u <DB_USER> -p <DB_NAME> < /tmp/backup.sql`
4. Go to the new website and verify the old data is present.
5. Log into the new website and verify user credentials work.
6. Change the DNS A record of your original wiki's name to the new server's IP address.
7. Update the new server's `$wgServer` value in `LocalSettings.php` to the old server's URL.